

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12386318
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
Inventor(s)	Park; Jihoon et al.

Electronic device including biometric recognizing module

Abstract

According to certain embodiments, an electronic device comprises: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing including a first window and a second window; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board connected to one surface of the first board; a first sensor circuit mounted on a first surface of the second board, disposed in the protrusion, and spaced apart from and under the first window; and a second sensor circuit mounted on a second surface of the second board facing in a direction opposite to the first surface of the second board, disposed in the protrusion, and spaced apart from and above the second window.

Inventors: Park; Jihoon (Gyeonggi-do, KR), Kim; Hyunwoo (Gyeonggi-do, KR), Heo; Jihun (Gyeonggi-do, KR), Hwang; Seungho (Gyeonggi-do, KR)

Applicant: Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd. (Gyeonggi-do, KR)

Family ID: 84543219

Assignee: Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd. (Suwon-si, KR)

Appl. No.: 17/748174

Filed: May 19, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220413449 A1	Dec. 29, 2022

Foreign Application Priority Data

KR	10-2021-0083705	Jun. 28, 2021
----	-----------------	---------------

Related U.S. Application Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06V40/13 (20220101); G04G17/04 (20060101); G04G21/02 (20100101); G06F21/32 (20130101); G06V40/10 (20220101); G06V40/12 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G04G21/025 (20130101); G04G17/04 (20130101); G06F21/32 (20130101); G06V40/1318 (20220101); G06V40/1365 (20220101); G06V40/15 (20220101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06V (40/13); G04G (21/02); G04G (17/04)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
9779277	12/2016	Ohtsuka et al.	N/A	N/A
10057470	12/2017	Kim et al.	N/A	N/A
10157590	12/2017	Aflatooni	N/A	G09G 5/10
10318958	12/2018	Kim	N/A	N/A
10594026	12/2019	Choi et al.	N/A	N/A
10866619	12/2019	Bushnell	N/A	G06F 1/169
10962935	12/2020	Ely et al.	N/A	N/A
11354933	12/2021	Lee et al.	N/A	N/A
2016/0091922	12/2015	Nazzaro	307/104	G04C 10/00
2016/0241553	12/2015	Kim	N/A	N/A
2017/0090599	12/2016	Kuboyama et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0323130	12/2016	Dickinson	N/A	G06V 40/1306
2018/0181733	12/2017	Shim et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0041962	12/2019	Beyhs	N/A	N/A
2022/0230011	12/2021	Wan	N/A	G06V 40/1318

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
716923	12/2020	CH	N/A
105045085	12/2014	CN	N/A
209950520	12/2019	CN	N/A
2002-323581	12/2001	JP	N/A
10-2016-0101497	12/2015	KR	N/A
10-2017-0053385	12/2016	KR	N/A
10-2021-0021657	12/2020	KR	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

US 10,222,753 B1, 03/2019, Ely (withdrawn) cited by applicant
Extended European Search Report dated Sep. 11, 2024. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Haley; Joseph R

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Cha & Reiter, LLC.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S) (1) This application is a continuation application, claiming priority under § 365(c), of an International application No. PCT/KR2022/006657, filed on May 10, 2022, which is based on and claims the benefit of a Korean patent application number 10-2021-0083705, filed on Jun. 28, 2021, in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the disclosure of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

Field

(1) Certain embodiments of the disclosure relate to an electronic device including a biometric recognition module.

Description of Related Art

(2) Wearable electronic devices, such as a smartwatch are commonplace. The wearable electronic devices are providing increasing numbers of functions.

(3) To measure a user's biometric information, various sensors may be mounted in the wearable electronic device. However, the positioning of the sensors raises several complications. For example, measuring biometric information through sensors on the front of the wearable electronic device may be difficult because of the front glass. The front glass may be thick for sturdiness, and hence measuring biometric information through sensors mounted in an in-display form may deteriorate in performance. When sensors are stacked adjacent to the rear plate of the wearable device, it may be difficult to keep the wearable electronic device thin.

(4) In certain embodiments of the disclosure, an electronic device may include a protrusion from the side of the electronic device. The protrusion can include a placement space where a plurality of biometric sensors are disposed. The biometric sensors are capable of measuring user's biometric information.

SUMMARY

(5) According to certain embodiments, an electronic device comprises: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing including a first window and a second window; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board connected to one surface of the first board; a first sensor circuit mounted on a first surface of the second board, disposed in the protrusion, and spaced apart from and under the first window; and a second sensor circuit mounted on a second surface of the second board facing in a direction opposite to the first surface of the second board, disposed in the protrusion, and spaced apart from and above the second window.

(6) According to certain embodiments, an electronic device comprises: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing including a first window and a second window; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board connected to one surface of the first board, and including a first surface, a second surface in a direction perpendicular to the first surface, and a third surface in a direction opposite to the first surface; a first sensor circuit mounted on the second surface of the second board and disposed inside the protrusion, wherein the first window is spaced apart on a side of the first sensor circuit; and a second sensor circuit mounted on the third surface of the second board, and disposed inside the protrusion, wherein the second window is spaced part and under the second sensor circuit.

(7) According to certain embodiments, an electronic device comprises: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing including a first window and a second window; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board connected to one surface of the first board; a third board electrically connected to the second board through a plurality of connection members; a first sensor circuit disposed on a first surface of the third board, and wherein the first window is spaced apart above the first sensor circuit; and a second sensor circuit disposed on a second surface of the third board, and wherein the second window disposed to be spaced apart under the second sensor circuit.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an electronic device in a network environment according to certain embodiments.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a front perspective view of an electronic device according to certain embodiments.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a rear perspective view of the electronic device of FIG. 2 according to certain embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 4 is an exploded perspective view of the electronic device of FIG. 2 according to certain embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 5A is a front view of the electronic device according to certain embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 5B is a cross-sectional view of the electronic device viewed along line A-A' according to certain embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of the electronic device viewed along line A-A' in FIG. 5A according to certain embodiments.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view of the electronic device viewed along line A-A' in FIG. 5A according to certain embodiments.
- (9) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional view of the electronic device viewed along line A-A' in FIG. 5A according to certain embodiments.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a view for explaining a window formed on one surface of a protrusion when the fingerprint sensor is made of an optical fingerprint sensor according to certain embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (11) In certain embodiments of the disclosure, the electronic device is provided with a plurality of biometric sensors capable of measuring user's biometric information disposed in the placement space of a biometric recognition module formed to protrude from the side of the electronic device, which not only improves the accuracy of biometric recognition but also enables slimming of the electronic device.
- (12) A wearable electronic device can include sensors for that provide biometric information, where the sensors have good performance, while maintaining the slimness of the housing. The wearable electronic device includes a protrusion from the housing. Since the protrusion might not include any portion of the display, the cover may be thinner, thereby allowing sensors facing the front to provide good performance. Additionally, since the protrusion is separate from the remaining body, the sensors that are inside the protrusion do not makes the wearable electronic device thicker.
- (13) FIG. 1-4 describe the wearable electronic device, the housing, and various internal components.
- (14) Electronic Device
- (15) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an electronic device **101** in a network environment **100** according to certain embodiments. The electronic device **101** can include a wearable electronic device.
- (16) Referring to FIG. 1, an electronic device **101** in a network environment **100** may communicate with an electronic device **102** via a first network **198** (e.g., a short-range wireless communication

network), or at least one of an electronic device **104** or a server **108** via a second network **199** (e.g., a long-range wireless communication network). According to an embodiment, the electronic device **101** may communicate with the electronic device **104** via the server **108**. According to an embodiment, the electronic device **101** may include a processor **120**, memory **130**, an input module **150**, a sound output module **155**, a display module **160**, an audio module **170**, a sensor module **176**, an interface **177**, a connection terminal **178**, a haptic module **179**, a camera module **180**, a power management module **188**, a battery **189**, a communication module **190**, a subscriber identification module (SIM) **196**, or an antenna module **197**. In some embodiments, at least one of the components (e.g., the connection terminal **178**) may be omitted from the electronic device **101**, or one or more other components may be added in the electronic device **101**. In some embodiments, some of the components (e.g., the sensor module **176**, the camera module **180**, or the antenna module **197**) may be implemented as a single component (e.g., the display module **160**).

(17) The processor **120** may execute, for example, software (e.g., a program **140**) to control at least one other component (e.g., a hardware or software component) of the electronic device **101** coupled with the processor **120**, and may perform various data processing or computation. According to one embodiment, as at least part of the data processing or computation, the processor **120** may store a command or data received from another component (e.g., the sensor module **176** or the communication module **190**) in volatile memory **132**, process the command or the data stored in the volatile memory **132**, and store resulting data in non-volatile memory **134**. According to an embodiment, the processor **120** may include a main processor **121** (e.g., a central processing unit (CPU) or an application processor (AP)), or an auxiliary processor **123** (e.g., a graphics processing unit (GPU), a neural processing unit (NPU), an image signal processor (ISP), a sensor hub processor, or a communication processor (CP)) that is operable independently from, or in conjunction with, the main processor **121**. For example, when the electronic device **101** includes the main processor **121** and the auxiliary processor **123**, the auxiliary processor **123** may be adapted to consume less power than the main processor **121**, or to be specific to a specified function. The auxiliary processor **123** may be implemented as separate from, or as part of the main processor **121**.

(18) The term “processor” shall be understood to refer to both the singular and plural contexts in this document.

(19) The auxiliary processor **123** may control at least some of functions or states related to at least one component (e.g., the display module **160**, the sensor module **176**, or the communication module **190**) among the components of the electronic device **101**, instead of the main processor **121** while the main processor **121** is in an inactive (e.g., sleep) state, or together with the main processor **121** while the main processor **121** is in an active state (e.g., executing an application). According to an embodiment, the auxiliary processor **123** (e.g., an image signal processor or a communication processor) may be implemented as part of another component (e.g., the camera module **180** or the communication module **190**) functionally related to the auxiliary processor **123**. According to an embodiment, the auxiliary processor **123** (e.g., the neural processing unit) may include a hardware structure specified for artificial intelligence model processing. An artificial intelligence model may be generated by machine learning. Such learning may be performed, e.g., by the electronic device **101** where the artificial intelligence is performed or via a separate server (e.g., the server **108**). Learning algorithms may include, but are not limited to, e.g., supervised learning, unsupervised learning, semi-supervised learning, or reinforcement learning. The artificial intelligence model may include a plurality of artificial neural network layers. The artificial neural network may be a deep neural network (DNN), a convolutional neural network (CNN), a recurrent neural network (RNN), a restricted boltzmann machine (RBM), a deep belief network (DBN), a bidirectional recurrent deep neural network (BRDNN), deep Q-network or a combination of two or more thereof but is not limited thereto. The artificial intelligence model may, additionally or alternatively, include a software structure other than the hardware structure.

(20) The memory **130** may store various data used by at least one component (e.g., the processor **120** or the sensor module **176**) of the electronic device **101**. The various data may include, for example, software (e.g., the program **140**) and input data or output data for a command related thereto. The memory **130** may include the volatile memory **132** or the non-volatile memory **134**. The non-volatile memory **134** may include an internal memory **136** and/or an external memory **138**.

(21) The program **140** may be stored in the memory **130** as software, and may include, for example, an operating system (OS) **142**, middleware **144**, or an application **146**.

(22) The input module **150** may receive a command or data to be used by another component (e.g., the processor **120**) of the electronic device **101**, from the outside (e.g., a user) of the electronic device **101**. The input module **150** may include, for example, a microphone, a mouse, a keyboard, a key (e.g., a button), or a digital pen (e.g., a stylus pen).

(23) The sound output module **155** may output sound signals to the outside of the electronic device **101**. The sound output module **155** may include, for example, a speaker or a receiver. The speaker may be used for general purposes, such as playing multimedia or playing record. The receiver may be used for receiving incoming calls. According to an embodiment, the receiver may be implemented as separate from, or as part of the speaker.

(24) The display module **160** may visually provide information to the outside (e.g., a user) of the electronic device **101**. The display module **160** may include, for example, a display, a hologram device, or a projector and control circuitry to control a corresponding one of the display, hologram device, and projector. According to an embodiment, the display module **160** may include a touch sensor adapted to detect a touch, or a pressure sensor adapted to measure the intensity of force incurred by the touch.

(25) The audio module **170** may convert a sound into an electrical signal and vice versa. According to an embodiment, the audio module **170** may obtain the sound via the input module **150**, or output the sound via the sound output module **155** or a headphone of an external electronic device (e.g., an electronic device **102**) (e.g., speaker or headphone) directly (e.g., wiredly) or wirelessly coupled with the electronic device **101**.

(26) The sensor module **176** may detect an operational state (e.g., power or temperature) of the electronic device **101** or an environmental state (e.g., a state of a user) external to the electronic device **101**, and then generate an electrical signal or data value corresponding to the detected state. According to an embodiment, the sensor module **176** may include, for example, a gesture sensor, a gyro sensor, an atmospheric pressure sensor, a magnetic sensor, an acceleration sensor, a grip sensor, a proximity sensor, a color sensor, an infrared (IR) sensor, a biometric sensor, a temperature sensor, a humidity sensor, or an illuminance sensor.

(27) The interface **177** may support one or more specified protocols to be used for the electronic device **101** to be coupled with the external electronic device (e.g., the electronic device **102**) directly (e.g., through wires) or wirelessly. According to an embodiment, the interface **177** may include, for example, a high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI), a universal serial bus (USB) interface, a secure digital (SD) card interface, or an audio interface.

(28) The connection terminal **178** may include a connector via which the electronic device **101** may be physically connected with the external electronic device (e.g., the electronic device **102**). According to an embodiment, the connection terminal **178** may include, for example, an HDMI connector, a USB connector, an SD card connector, or an audio connector (e.g., a headphone connector).

(29) The haptic module **179** may convert an electrical signal into a mechanical stimulus (e.g., a vibration or a movement) or electrical stimulus which may be recognized by a user via his tactile sensation or kinesthetic sensation. According to an embodiment, the haptic module **179** may include, for example, a motor, a piezoelectric element, or an electric stimulator.

(30) The camera module **180** may capture a still image or moving images. According to an

embodiment, the camera module **180** may include one or more lenses, image sensors, image signal processors, or flashes.

(31) The power management module **188** may manage power supplied to the electronic device **101**. According to one embodiment, the power management module **188** may be implemented as at least part of, for example, a power management integrated circuit (PMIC).

(32) The battery **189** may supply power to at least one component of the electronic device **101**. According to an embodiment, the battery **189** may include, for example, a primary cell which is not rechargeable, a secondary cell which is rechargeable, or a fuel cell.

(33) The communication module **190** may support establishing a direct (e.g., wired) communication channel or a wireless communication channel between the electronic device **101** and the external electronic device (e.g., the electronic device **102**, the electronic device **104**, or the server **108**) and performing communication via the established communication channel. The communication module **190** may include one or more communication processors that are operable independently from the processor **120** (e.g., an application processor (AP)) and supports a direct (e.g., wired) communication or a wireless communication. According to an embodiment, the communication module **190** may include a wireless communication module **192** (e.g., a cellular communication module, a short-range wireless communication module, or a global navigation satellite system (GNSS) communication module) or a wired communication module **194** (e.g., a local area network (LAN) communication module or a power line communication (PLC) module). A corresponding one of these communication modules may communicate with the external electronic device via the first network **198** (e.g., a short-range communication network, such as Bluetooth™, Wi-Fi direct, or infrared data association (IrDA)) or the second network **199** (e.g., a long-range communication network, such as a legacy cellular network, a fifth generation (5G) network, a next-generation communication network, the Internet, or a computer network (e.g., LAN or wide area network (WAN))). These various types of communication modules may be implemented as a single component (e.g., a single chip), or may be implemented as multi components (e.g., multi chips) separate from each other. The wireless communication module **192** may identify and authenticate the electronic device **101** in a communication network, such as the first network **198** or the second network **199**, using subscriber information (e.g., international mobile subscriber identity (IMSI)) stored in the subscriber identification module **196**.

(34) The wireless communication module **192** may support a 5G network, after a 4G network, and next-generation communication technology, e.g., new radio (NR) access technology. The NR access technology may support enhanced mobile broadband (eMBB), massive machine type communications (mMTC), or ultra-reliable and low-latency communications (URLLC). The wireless communication module **192** may support a high-frequency band (e.g., the mmWave band) to achieve, e.g., a high data transmission rate. The wireless communication module **192** may support various technologies for securing performance on a high-frequency band, such as, e.g., beamforming, massive multiple-input and multiple-output (massive MIMO), full dimensional MIMO (FD-MIMO), array antenna, analog beam-forming, or large-scale antenna. The wireless communication module **192** may support various requirements specified in the electronic device **101**, an external electronic device (e.g., the electronic device **104**), or a network system (e.g., the second network **199**). According to an embodiment, the wireless communication module **192** may support a peak data rate (e.g., 20 Gbps or more) for implementing eMBB, loss coverage (e.g., 164 dB or less) for implementing mMTC, or U-plane latency (e.g., 0.5 ms or less for each of downlink (DL) and uplink (UL), or a round trip of 1 ms or less) for implementing URLLC.

(35) The antenna module **197** may transmit or receive a signal or power to or from the outside (e.g., the external electronic device) of the electronic device **101**. According to an embodiment, the antenna module **197** may include an antenna including a radiating element composed of a conductive material or a conductive pattern formed in or on a substrate (e.g., a printed circuit board (PCB)). According to an embodiment, the antenna module **197** may include a plurality of antennas

(e.g., array antennas). In such a case, at least one antenna appropriate for a communication scheme used in the communication network, such as the first network **198** or the second network **199**, may be selected, for example, by the communication module **190** (e.g., the wireless communication module **192**) from the plurality of antennas. The signal or the power may then be transmitted or received between the communication module **190** and the external electronic device via the selected at least one antenna. According to an embodiment, another component (e.g., a radio frequency integrated circuit (RFIC)) other than the radiating element may be additionally formed as part of the antenna module **197**.

(36) According to certain embodiments, the antenna module **197** may form mmWave antenna module. According to an embodiment, the mmWave antenna module may include a printed circuit board, a RFIC disposed on a first surface (e.g., the bottom surface) of the printed circuit board, or adjacent to the first surface and capable of supporting a designated high-frequency band (e.g., an mmwave band), and a plurality of antennas (e.g., array antennas) disposed on a second surface (e.g., the top or a side surface) of the printed circuit board, or adjacent to the second surface and capable of transmitting or receiving signals of the designated high-frequency band.

(37) At least some of the above-described components may be coupled mutually and communicate signals (e.g., commands or data) therebetween via an inter-peripheral communication scheme (e.g., a bus, general purpose input and output (GPIO), serial peripheral interface (SPI), or mobile industry processor interface (MIPI)).

(38) According to an embodiment, commands or data may be transmitted or received between the electronic device **101** and the external electronic device **104** via the server **108** coupled with the second network **199**. Each of the electronic devices **102** or **104** may be a device of a same type as, or a different type, from the electronic device **101**. According to an embodiment, all or some of operations to be executed at the electronic device **101** may be executed at one or more of the external electronic devices **102**, **104**, or **108**. For example, if the electronic device **101** should perform a function or a service automatically, or in response to a request from a user or another device, the electronic device **101**, instead of, or in addition to, executing the function or the service, may request the one or more external electronic devices to perform at least part of the function or the service. The one or more external electronic devices receiving the request may perform the at least part of the function or the service requested, or an additional function or an additional service related to the request, and transfer an outcome of the performing to the electronic device **101**. The electronic device **101** may provide the outcome, with or without further processing of the outcome, as at least part of a reply to the request. To that end, a cloud computing, distributed computing, mobile edge computing (MEC), or client-server computing technology may be used, for example. The electronic device **101** may provide ultra low-latency services using, e.g., distributed computing or mobile edge computing. In another embodiment, the external electronic device **104** may include an internet-of-things (IoT) device. The server **108** may be an intelligent server using machine learning and/or a neural network. According to an embodiment, the external electronic device **104** or the server **108** may be included in the second network **199**. The electronic device **101** may be applied to intelligent services (e.g., smart home, smart city, smart car, or healthcare) based on 5G communication technology or IoT-related technology.

(39) The electronic device according to certain embodiments may be one of various types of electronic devices. The electronic devices may include, for example, a portable communication device (e.g., a smartphone), a computer device, a portable multimedia device, a portable medical device, a camera, a wearable device, or a home appliance. According to an embodiment of the disclosure, the electronic devices are not limited to those described above.

(40) It should be appreciated that certain embodiments of the disclosure and the terms used therein are not intended to limit the technological features set forth herein to particular embodiments and include various changes, equivalents, or replacements for a corresponding embodiment. With regard to the description of the drawings, similar reference numerals may be used to refer to similar

or related elements. It is to be understood that a singular form of a noun corresponding to an item may include one or more of the things, unless the relevant context clearly indicates otherwise. As used herein, each of such phrases as “A or B,” “at least one of A and B,” “at least one of A or B,” “A, B, or C,” “at least one of A, B, and C,” and “at least one of A, B, or C,” may include any one of, or all possible combinations of the items enumerated together in a corresponding one of the phrases. As used herein, such terms as “1st” and “2nd,” or “first” and “second” may be used to simply distinguish a corresponding component from another, and does not limit the components in other aspect (e.g., importance or order). It is to be understood that if an element (e.g., a first element) is referred to, with or without the term “operatively” or “communicatively,” as “coupled with,” “coupled to,” “connected with,” or “connected to” another element (e.g., a second element), it means that the element may be coupled with the other element directly (e.g., through wires), wirelessly, or via a third element.

(41) As used in connection with certain embodiments of the disclosure, the term “module” may include a unit implemented in hardware, software, or firmware, and may interchangeably be used with other terms, for example, “logic,” “logic block,” “part,” or “circuitry.” A module may be a single integral component, or a minimum unit or part thereof, adapted to perform one or more functions. For example, according to an embodiment, the module may be implemented in a form of an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC).

(42) Certain embodiments as set forth herein may be implemented as software (e.g., the program **140**) including one or more instructions that are stored in a storage medium (e.g., internal memory **136** or external memory **138**) that is readable by a machine (e.g., the electronic device **101**). For example, a processor (e.g., the processor **120**) of the machine (e.g., the electronic device **101**) may invoke at least one of the one or more instructions stored in the storage medium, and execute it, with or without using one or more other components under the control of the processor. This allows the machine to be operated to perform at least one function according to the at least one instruction invoked. The one or more instructions may include a code generated by a compiler or a code executable by an interpreter. The machine-readable storage medium may be provided in the form of a non-transitory storage medium. Wherein, the term “non-transitory” simply means that the storage medium is a tangible device, and does not include a signal (e.g., an electromagnetic wave), but this term does not differentiate between where data is semi-permanently stored in the storage medium and where the data is temporarily stored in the storage medium.

(43) According to an embodiment, a method according to certain embodiments of the disclosure may be included and provided in a computer program product. The computer program product may be traded as a product between a seller and a buyer. The computer program product may be distributed in the form of a machine-readable storage medium (e.g., compact disc read only memory (CD-ROM)), or be distributed (e.g., downloaded or uploaded) online via an application store (e.g., PlayStore™), or between two user devices (e.g., smart phones) directly. If distributed online, at least part of the computer program product may be temporarily generated or at least temporarily stored in the machine-readable storage medium, such as memory of the manufacturer's server, a server of the application store, or a relay server.

(44) According to certain embodiments, each component (e.g., a module or a program) of the above-described components may include a single entity or multiple entities, and some of the multiple entities may be separately disposed in different components. According to certain embodiments, one or more of the above-described components may be omitted, or one or more other components may be added. Alternatively or additionally, a plurality of components (e.g., modules or programs) may be integrated into a single component. In such a case, according to certain embodiments, the integrated component may still perform one or more functions of each of the plurality of components in the same or similar manner as they are performed by a corresponding one of the plurality of components before the integration. According to certain embodiments, operations performed by the module, the program, or another component may be

carried out sequentially, in parallel, repeatedly, or heuristically, or one or more of the operations may be executed in a different order or omitted, or one or more other operations may be added.

(45) In certain embodiments, the electronic device is a wearable electronic device that includes a sensor module **176**. However, as will be shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**, the wearable electronic device includes protrusion. The sensor module **176** can be disposed in the protrusion. Since the protrusion is separate from the display module **160** surface, the cover may be thinner. This allows improved performance by sensors facing the front of the wearable electronic device. Additionally, sensors can face the rear without increasing the thickness of the electronic device.

(46) Housing

(47) FIG. **2** is a front perspective view of an electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments. FIG. **3** is a rear perspective view of the electronic device **400** of FIG. **2** according to certain embodiments. The wearable electronic device **400** includes protrusion **206**. The sensors capable of providing biometric information can be disposed in the protrusion **206**.

(48) With reference to FIGS. **2** and **3**, in one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may include a housing **210** including a first surface (or, front surface) **210A**, a second surface (or, rear surface) **210B**, and a side surface **210C** surrounding the space between the first surface **210A** and the second surface **210B**, and fastening members **250** and connected to at least a portion of the housing **210** and configured to detachably fasten the electronic device **400** to a body part (e.g., wrist, ankle, etc.) of the user. In another embodiment (not shown), the housing **210** may refer to a structure forming some of the first surface **210A**, the second surface **210B**, and the side surface **210C** in FIG. **2**. In one embodiment, the first surface **210A** may be formed by a front plate **201** that is substantially transparent at least in part (e.g., glass plate containing various coating layers, or polymer plate). The second surface **210B** may be formed by a rear plate **207** that is substantially opaque. The rear plate **207** may be made of, for example, coated or colored glass, ceramic, polymer, metal (e.g., aluminum, stainless steel (STS), or magnesium), or a combination thereof. The side surface **210C** is coupled to the front plate **201** and the rear plate **207** and may be formed by a side bezel structure (or, side member) **211** containing metal and/or polymer. In a certain embodiment, the rear plate **207** and the side bezel structure **211** may be integrally formed and contain the same material (e.g., metal material such as aluminum). The fastening members **250** and **260** may be made of various materials and formed in various shapes. The fastening members **250** and **260** may be formed as a single body or as plural unit links that are movable with each other, by woven material, leather, rubber, urethane, metal, ceramic, or a combination thereof.

(49) In one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may include at least one of a display (e.g., display **220** in FIG. **4**), an audio module **205** and **208**, a sensor module, key input devices **202**, **203** and **204**, or a connector hole **209**. In a certain embodiment, at least one of the components (e.g., key input device **202**, **203** and **204**, connector hole **209**) may be removed from the electronic device **400**, or a different component may be added to the electronic device **400**.

(50) The display **220** can be viewed through, for example, a significant portion of the front plate **201**. The display **220** may have a shape corresponding to the shape of the front plate **201** and may have one of various shapes such as a circle, an ellipse, and a polygon. The display **220** may be disposed in combination with or adjacent to a touch sensing circuit, a pressure sensor capable of measuring the intensity (pressure) of a touch.

(51) The audio module **205** and **208** may include a microphone hole **205** and a speaker hole **208**. In the microphone hole **205**, a microphone for picking up external sounds may be disposed therein, and plural microphones may be arranged to sense the direction of sound in a certain embodiment. The speaker hole **208** can be used for an external speaker and a call receiver. In a certain embodiment, the speaker hole **208** and the microphone hole **205** may be implemented as a single hole, or a speaker (e.g., piezo speaker) may be included without the speaker hole **208**.

(52) The sensor module may generate an electrical signal or data value corresponding to an internal operating state of the electronic device **400** or an external environmental state. The sensor module

may include, for example, a biometric sensor module (e.g., fingerprint sensor and/or HRM sensor). The electronic device **400** may further include a sensor module (not shown) including at least one of, for example, a gesture sensor, a gyro sensor, an air pressure sensor, a magnetic sensor, an acceleration sensor, a grip sensor, a color sensor, an infrared (IR) sensor, a biometric sensor, a temperature sensor, a humidity sensor, or an illuminance sensor.

(53) The key input devices **202**, **203** and **204** may include a wheel key **202** disposed on the first surface **210A** of the housing **210** and rotatable in at least one direction, and/or side key buttons **203** and **204** disposed on the side surface **210C** of the housing **210**. The wheel key may have a shape corresponding to the shape of the front plate **201**. In another embodiment, the electronic device **400** may not include some or all of the key input devices **202**, **203** and **204** described above, and the key input device **202**, **203** or **204** that is not included may be implemented in other forms, such as soft keys, on the display **220**. The connector hole **209** may accommodate a connector (e.g., USB connector) for transmitting and receiving power and/or data to and from an external electronic device, and may include another connector hole (not shown) that can accommodate a connector for transmitting and receiving an audio signal to and from an external electronic device. The electronic device **400** may further include, for example, a connector cover (not shown) that covers at least a portion of the connector hole **209** and blocks foreign substances from entering the connector hole **209**.

(54) The fastening members **250** and **260** may be detachably fastened to at least a portion of the housing **210** by using locking members **251** and **261**. The fastening members **250** and **260** may include one or more of a fixing member **252**, fixing member fastening holes **253**, a band guide member **254**, and a band fixing ring **255**.

(55) The fixing member **252** may be configured to fix the housing **210** and the fastening members **250** and **260** to a body part (e.g., wrist, or ankle) of the user. The fixing member fastening holes **253** may fix the housing **210** and the fastening members **250** and **260** to a body part of the user in correspondence to the fixing member **252**. The band guide member **254** may be configured to limit the range of movement of the fixing member **252** when the fixing member **252** engages with a fixing member fastening hole **253**, so that the fastening members **250** and **260** may be fastened in close contact to a body part of the user. The band fixing ring **255** may limit the range of movement of the fastening members **250** and **260** while the fixing member **252** and the fixing member fastening hole **253** are fastened.

(56) FIG. 4 is an exploded perspective view of an electronic device according to certain embodiments.

(57) With reference to FIG. 4, the electronic device **400** (e.g., electronic device **400** in FIGS. 2 and 3) may include a housing **410** (e.g., housing **210** in FIG. 2), a wheel key **202**, a front plate **201**, a display **220**, a first antenna **450**, a second antenna **455**, a support member **460** (e.g., bracket), a battery **470**, a printed circuit board **480**, a flexible printed circuit board **485**, a sealing member **490**, a rear plate **493** (e.g., a rear plate **207** in FIG. 3), and fastening members **495**, **497** (e.g., fastening members **250** and **260** in FIGS. 2 and 3). At least one of the components of the electronic device **400** may be identical or similar to at least one of the components of the electronic device **400** of FIG. 2 or 3, and repeated descriptions are omitted herein. In one embodiment, the housing **410** includes a side bezel structure (e.g., side bezel structure **211**). The support member **460** disposed inside the electronic device **400** may be formed to be connected to the housing **410** or be integrally formed with the housing **410**. The support member **460** may be made of, for example, a metal material and/or a non-metal (e.g., polymer) material. The support member **460** may have one surface coupled to the display **220**, or the other surface coupled to the printed circuit board **480**. A processor (e.g., processor **120** in FIG. 1), a memory (e.g., memory **130** in FIG. 1), and/or an interface (e.g., interface **177** in FIG. 1) may be mounted on the printed circuit board **480**. The flexible printed circuit board **485** may be connected to one surface of the printed circuit board **480**. The flexible printed circuit board **485** may be equipped with at least one sensor (e.g., sensor

module **176** in FIG. **1**) (e.g., biometric sensor and/or an illuminance sensor) and/or a light source.

(58) The battery **470** is a device for supplying power to at least one component of the electronic device **400**, and may include, for example, a non-rechargeable primary cell, a rechargeable secondary cell, or a fuel cell. At least a portion of the battery **470** may be disposed substantially on the same plane as, for example, the printed circuit board **480**. The battery **470** may be disposed as a single body within the electronic device **400** or may be detachably disposed from the electronic device **400**.

(59) The first antenna **450** may be disposed between the display **220** and the support member **241**. The first antenna **450** may include, for example, a near field communication (NEC) antenna, a wireless charging antenna, and/or a magnetic secure transmission (MST) antenna. For example, the antenna **243** may perform short-range communication with an external device, wirelessly transmit or receive power required for charging, and transmit a short-range communication signal or a magnetic-based signal including payment data. In another embodiment, an antenna structure may be formed by using portions of the housing **410** and/or the support member **460** or a combination thereof.

(60) The second antenna **455** may be disposed between the printed circuit board **480** and the rear plate **493**. The second antenna **455** may include, for example, a near field communication (NEC) antenna, a wireless charging antenna, and/or a magnetic secure transmission (MST) antenna. For example, second antenna **455** may perform short-range communication with an external device, wirelessly transmit or receive power required for charging, and transmit a short-range communication signal or a magnetic-based signal including payment data. In another embodiment, an antenna structure may be formed by using portions of the housing **410** and/or the rear plate **493** or a combination thereof.

(61) The sealing member **490** may be positioned between the housing **410** and the rear plate **493**. The sealing member **490** may be configured to block moisture and foreign matter flowing into the space surrounded by the housing **410** and the rear plate **207** from the outside.

(62) FIG. **5A** is a front view **500** of the electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments. FIG. **5B** is a cross-sectional view **550** of the electronic device **400** viewed along line A-A' according to certain embodiments.

(63) The electronic device **400** includes a housing **210** with a protrusion **206**. Various sensors may be disposed in the protrusion **206**. The interior of the housing **210** and the interior of the protrusion are connected by a tunnel **510**. The housing **210** can include a printed circuit board **480**, on which electronic components, such as one or more processors, may be mounted. The sensors module **176** may be connected to the one or more processors by flexible printed circuit board **485** that is disposed in the tunnel **510**.

(64) The electronic device **400** including the components and operations described in certain embodiments of this document may include an electronic device that can be in contact with the user's body. In one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may be a wearable electronic device that can be worn on the user's body. Hereinafter, the electronic device **400** in the form of a wrist watch shown in FIGS. **2** to **4** will be described as representative examples. However, the form of the electronic device according to certain embodiments of this document is not limited to the electronic device **400**.

(65) With reference to FIGS. **5A** and **5B**, the electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may include a main body. The main body may mean a part constituting the external appearance of the electronic device **400**. For example, the main body may include a housing structure described with reference to FIGS. **2** to **4** (e.g., the housing **210** including the first surface (or, front surface) **210A**, the second surface (or, rear surface) **210B**, and the side surface **210C** surrounding the space between the first surface **210A** and the second surface **210B** in FIGS. **2** and **3**).

(66) The electronic device **400** may include a printed circuit board **480** disposed in the internal

space of the housing **210**. For example, a processor (e.g., processor **120** in FIG. **1**), a memory (e.g., memory **130** in FIG. **1**) and/or an interface (e.g., interface **177** in FIG. **1**) may be mounted on the printed circuit board **480**. However, this is not limited thereto.

(67) In one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may include a flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the printed circuit board **480**.

In one embodiment, a plurality of biometric sensors (e.g., sensor module **176** in FIG. **1**) for obtaining user's biometric information may be mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485**. For example, the plurality of biometric sensors may include sensors having a function of obtaining user's biometric information, such as fingerprint, electrocardiogram (ECG), respiration, electromyography (EMG), electrooculogram (EOG), electroencephalogram (EEG), blood glucose, saturation of peripheral oxygen (SpO₂), photoplethysmography (PPG), heart rate monitoring (HRM), and/or body temperature.

(68) In the following examples according to certain embodiments, the plurality of biometric sensors mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** will be described on the assumption that they are a fingerprint sensor and a heart rate sensor.

(69) This is not limited thereto, and a light source and/or an illuminance sensor may be further mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** in certain embodiments.

(70) A plurality of sensors (e.g., plural biometric sensors and/or illuminance sensor) mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be electrically connected to the processor **120** mounted on the printed circuit board **480**. As the plural sensors (e.g., plural biometric sensors and/or illuminance sensor) mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** are electrically connected to the processor **120** mounted on the printed circuit board **480**, the processor **120** may obtain the user's biometric information and/or detect the proximity of an external object (e.g., body portion of the user) through the plural sensors.

(71) The electronic device **400** may include a protrusion **206** (e.g., structure) that protrudes from one side of the housing **210** and includes an internal space **530**. In one embodiment, at least some of the outer shape of the protrusion **206** may be made of a transparent window. For example, the protrusion **206** may include a first surface **520a** (e.g., first surface **520a** facing in z-axis direction), a second surface **520b** facing in a direction perpendicular to the first surface **520a** (e.g., second surface **520b** facing in x-axis direction), and a third surface **520c** facing in a direction perpendicular to the second surface **520b** (e.g., third surface **520c** facing in negative z-axis direction). In other words, at least a portion of the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** of the protrusion **206** may be made of a light-transmitting material that transmits light, for example, a window.

(72) The electronic device **400** may include a hole **510** (e.g., tunnel) connecting the housing **210** and the protrusion **206**.

(73) At least a portion of the flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the printed circuit board **480** may pass through the hole **510** to be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**. For example, the at least a portion of the flexible printed circuit board **485** disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206** may be a region in which a plurality of sensors (e.g., plural biometric sensors and/or illuminance sensor) are disposed. In other words, at least a portion of the flexible printed circuit board **485** (e.g., region in which a plurality of sensors are disposed) may be disposed to be spaced apart, in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**, from the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** forming the outer shape of the protrusion **206**.

(74) In certain embodiments, an external object, for example, a body portion of the user, may be positioned on the outer shape of the protrusion **206** made of a window, for example, on the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c**. The body portion of the user may include a finger and/or a wrist of the user. When a body portion of the user is positioned on the outer shape of the protrusion **206** made of a window, for example, on the first surface **520a**, the

second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c**, user's biometric information may be obtained through biometric sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor and/or heart rate sensor) disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**. For example, user's biometric information may include fingerprint information and/or heart rate information of the user.

(75) In certain embodiments, based on a body portion of the user positioned on the outer shape of the protrusion **206** made of a light-transmitting material such as a window, for example, on the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c**, the protrusion **206** may operate as a biometric recognition module that obtains user's biometric information through plural biometric sensors mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**. Hereinafter, the protrusion **206** according to certain embodiments may be referred to as a biometric recognition module.

(76) Certain embodiments, regarding the structure of the flexible printed circuit board **485** including a plurality of sensors disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206** according to certain embodiments, will be described with reference to FIGS. **6** to **8** below.

(77) FIG. **6** is a cross-sectional view **600** of the electronic device **400** viewed along line A-A' in FIG. **5A** according to certain embodiments.

(78) With reference to FIG. **6**, the electronic device **400** may include a housing **210** that includes a first surface, a second surface, and a side surface surrounding the space between the first surface **210A** and the second surface **210B**.

(79) The electronic device **400** may include a printed circuit board **480** disposed in the internal space of the housing **210**.

(80) In one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may include a flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the printed circuit board **480**. A plurality of sensors may be mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485**. The plurality of sensors may include fingerprint sensor, electrocardiogram (ECG) sensor, electromyography (EMG) sensor, electrooculogram (EOG) sensor, electroencephalogram (EEG) sensor, blood glucose sensor, oxygen saturation (SpO₂) sensor, photoplethysmography (PPG) sensor, heart rate (HRM) sensor, and/or illuminance sensor.

(81) In the description of FIG. **6** according to certain embodiments, it is assumed that the plurality of sensors mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** are a fingerprint sensor **610**, a heart rate sensor **630**, and an illuminance sensor **640**. For example, the fingerprint sensor **610** and the illuminance sensor **640** may be mounted on the first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the flexible printed circuit board **485**. The heart rate sensor **630** may be mounted on the second surface of the flexible printed circuit board **485** (e.g., second surface facing in a direction (e.g., negative z-axis direction) opposite to the direction in which the first surface of the flexible printed circuit board **485** faces (e.g., z-axis direction)). Without being limited thereto, a light source **620** may be further mounted on the first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the flexible printed circuit board **485**.

(82) The electronic device **400** may include a protrusion **206** (e.g., structure) that protrudes from one side surface of the housing **210** and includes an internal space **530**. In one embodiment, at least some of the outer shape of the protrusion **206** may be made of a transparent window. For example, the protrusion **206** may include a first surface **520a**, a second surface **520b** facing in a direction perpendicular to the first surface **520a**, and a third surface **520c** facing in a direction perpendicular to the second surface **520b**. At least a portion of the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** of the structure may be made of a transparent window. As another example, at least a portion of the first surface **520a** of the protrusion **206** disposed to be spaced apart from the fingerprint sensor **610** mounted on the first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be made of a transparent window. At least a portion of the third surface **520c** of the protrusion **206** disposed to be spaced apart from the heart rate sensor **630** mounted on the second surface (e.g., second surface facing in negative z-axis

direction) of the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be made of a transparent window.

(83) The electronic device **400** may include a hole **510** (e.g., tunnel) connecting the housing **210** and the protrusion **206**. At least a portion of the flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface of the printed circuit board **480** may pass through the hole **510** to be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**.

(84) When a body portion of the user is positioned on a light-transmitting material, for example, one surface (e.g., first surface **520a** and/or third surface **520c**) of the protrusion **206**, a user's biometric information (e.g., fingerprint information and/or heart rate information) can be obtained through multiple biometric sensors disposed in the internal space **530**. Accordingly, the protrusion **206** may operate as a biometric recognition module.

(85) In one embodiment, a plurality of sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**, heart rate sensor **630**, and/or illuminance sensor **640**) mounted on the first surface and the second surface of the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be electrically connected to the processor **120** mounted on the printed circuit board **480**. In one embodiment, the processor **120** may detect whether an external object approaches the first surface **520a** of the protrusion **206** based on a sensor signal obtained through the illuminance sensor **640**. For example, the external object may include a body portion of the user such as a finger or a wrist.

(86) Upon detecting by the illuminance sensor **640** that an external object (e.g., user's finger) is located on the first surface **520a** of the protrusion **206**, the processor **120** may activate a biometric sensor (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**). For example, at least a portion of the first surface **520a** may be made of a light-transmitting material. The light transmitting material may be, for example, a transparent window so as to receive light that is emitted by the light source **620**. The light may be emitted by the light source **620** to an external object (e.g., user's finger) on the first surface **520a** and reflected by the external object. In one embodiment, when an external object is located on the first surface **520a**, light generated from the light source **620** may be irradiated toward the external object. The fingerprint sensor **610** may receive light reflected from the external object. The fingerprint sensor **610** may obtain user's fingerprint information based on light reflected from the external object.

(87) The foregoing describe detecting an external object using an illuminance sensor, but the disclosure is not limited thereto. For example, the illuminance sensor **640** may measure ambient brightness. The processor **120** may adjust the brightness of the display (e.g., display module **160** in FIG. 1 or display **220** in FIG. 4) based on an ambient brightness value measured through the illuminance sensor **640**.

(88) In one embodiment, when detecting a user input for obtaining user's heart rate information, the processor **120** may activate the heart rate sensor **630**. At least a portion of the third surface **520c** may be made of a light-transmitting material, for example, a transparent window. When the user wears the electronic device **400**, the third surface **520c** of the protrusion **206** may be positioned to make contact with a body portion of the user, for example, the back of the user's wrist. The heart rate sensor **630** may include a light emitting part (not shown) that generates incident light and irradiates the light to an external object. The heart rate sensor **630** may also include a light receiving part (not shown, a photodiode, for example) that receives light reflected from the external object. The light emitting part (not shown) of the heart rate sensor **630** may emit light to the back of the user's wrist. The light reflected by back of the user's wrist may be received through the light receiving part (not shown) of the heart rate sensor **630**. The heart rate sensor **630** may measure information related to the user's heart rate based on the light received through the light receiving part (not shown).

(89) An electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may include: a housing **210**; a protrusion (e.g., protrusion **206**) from a side surface of the housing including a first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the first surface **520a**) and a second window (e.g., second window formed on at least a portion of the third surface **520c**), a first board (e.g., printed

circuit board **480**) disposed inside the housing **210**; a second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**) connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**); a first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) mounted on a first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**), disposed in the protrusions, and spaced apart from and under the first window; a second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) mounted on a second surface of the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**) facing in an opposite direction (e.g., negative z-axis direction) to the first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**); and disposed in the protrusion, and spaced apart from and above the second window.

(90) In certain embodiments, the first board may include a printed circuit board **480**, and the second board may include a flexible printed circuit board **485**.

(91) The electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may further include a hole **510** connecting an internal space of the housing **210** and an internal space of the protrusion **206**.

(92) In certain embodiments, the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**) may pass through the hole **510** from one surface of the first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**) and be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**.

(93) In certain embodiments, the first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the first surface **520a**) of the protrusion **206** may be configured to contact a finger of the user, and the second window (e.g., second window formed on at least a portion of the third surface **520c**) of the protrusion **206** may be formed to contact a wrist of the user.

(94) The electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may further include an illuminance sensor **640** and/or a light source **620** mounted on the first surface of the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**).

(95) In certain embodiments, the first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) and the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) mounted on the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**) may be electrically connected to a processor **120** mounted on the first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**).

(96) In certain embodiments, the processor **120** may be configured to: detect whether a body portion of the user is placed on the first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the first surface **520a**) through the illuminance sensor **640**; when the body portion of the user is placed on the first window, activate the first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) and/or the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**); and obtain biometric information of the user through the first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) and/or the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**).

(97) In certain embodiments, the first sensor circuit may include a fingerprint sensor **610**, and the processor **120** may be configured to: emit, based on detecting a finger of the user on the first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the first surface **520a**), light to the user's finger through the light source **620**; and obtain fingerprint information of the user based on receiving the emitted light that has been reflected by the user's finger detected on the first window through the fingerprint sensor **610**.

(98) In certain embodiments, when the fingerprint sensor **610** is an optical fingerprint sensor, a lens may be applied to the first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the first surface **520a**) and/or the second window (e.g., second window formed on at least a portion of the third surface **520c**) to increase the area for concentrating light reflected by the finger.

(99) In certain embodiments, the second sensor circuit may include a heart rate sensor **630**, and the processor **120** may be configured to obtain heart rate information of the user based on emitting light toward the user's wrist through a light emitting part of the heart rate sensor **630** and receiving the emitted light that has been reflected by the user's wrist through a light receiving part of the heart rate sensor **630**.

(100) In certain embodiments, the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be supported laterally in the protrusion **206**.

(101) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view **700** of the electronic device **400** viewed along line A-A' in FIG. 5A according to certain embodiments.

(102) In describing the components of the electronic device **400** shown in FIG. 7, the same reference symbols are assigned to the components substantially the same as those of the electronic device **400** described above in FIG. 6, and detailed descriptions thereof may be omitted.

(103) With reference to FIG. 7, the electronic device **400** may include a printed circuit board **480** disposed in the internal space of the housing **210**. The electronic device **400** may include a flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface of the printed circuit board **480**.

(104) In one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may include a protrusion **206** that protrudes from one side surface of the housing **210** and includes an internal space **530**. In one embodiment, at least a portion of the outer shape of the protrusion **206**, for example, the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** may be made of a transparent window.

(105) In one embodiment, the electronic device **400** may include a hole **510** (e.g., tunnel) connecting an internal space the housing **210** and the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**. At least a portion of the flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface of the printed circuit board **480** may pass through the hole **510** to be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**. For example, the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206** while being folded at least once. For instance, the flexible printed circuit board **485** may include a first surface facing in a first direction (e.g., z-axis direction), a second surface facing in a second direction (e.g., x-axis direction) perpendicular to the first direction (e.g., z-axis direction), and a third surface facing in a third direction (e.g., negative z-axis direction) perpendicular to the second direction (e.g., x-axis direction). The flexible printed circuit board **485** may be formed in an inverted '□' shape, and may be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206**.

(106) Based on a body portion of the user (e.g., user's finger and/or wrist) making contact on the outer shape, for example, the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c**, the protrusion **206** may operate as a biometric recognition module that obtains biometric information of the user through a plurality of biometric sensors mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485**.

(107) In one embodiment, the fingerprint sensor **610** may be mounted on the second surface (e.g., second surface facing in second direction (e.g., x-axis direction)) of the flexible printed circuit board **485**. A light source **620** may be further mounted on the second surface of the flexible printed circuit board **485**. A heart rate sensor **630** may be mounted on the third surface (e.g., third surface facing in third direction (e.g., negative z-axis direction)) of the flexible printed circuit board **485**.

(108) In one embodiment, the flexible printed circuit board **485** may further include a magnet **710** (e.g., magnetic material) mounted at a position corresponding to the heart rate sensor **630** in a fourth surface (e.g., fourth surface facing in first direction (e.g., z-axis direction)) opposite to the third surface of the flexible printed circuit board **485**. The magnet **710** may serve to fix the heart rate sensor **630** to prevent movement. For example, the heart rate sensor **630** and the magnet **710** may be mounted so that their central axes coincide. This prevents the heart rate sensor **630** from moving on the flexible printed circuit board **485**, and provides improved mounting stability.

(109) In FIG. 7 according to certain embodiments, the protrusion **206** may be implemented to be pushable. When an input signal to the protrusion **206** is detected, the processor **120** may activate a plurality of biometric sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610** and/or heart rate sensor **630**) to obtain user's biometric information. In one embodiment, the input signal to the protrusion **206** may include a signal caused by a body portion (e.g., finger) of the user physically pushing the second surface **520b** of the protrusion **206** toward the housing **210** (or, main body) of the electronic device **400** (e.g., in negative x-axis direction).

(110) An electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may include: a housing **210**; a protrusion (e.g., protrusion **206**) from a side surface of the housing including a first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the second surface **520b**) and a second window (e.g., second window formed on at least a portion of the third surface **520c**); a first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**) disposed inside the housing **210**; a second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**) connected to one surface of the first board, and including a first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction), a second surface in a direction perpendicular to the first surface (e.g., x-axis direction), and a third surface in a direction opposite to the first surface (e.g., negative z-axis direction); a first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) mounted on the second surface of the second board and disposed inside the protrusion, wherein the first window is spaced apart on a side of the first sensor circuit; and a second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) mounted on the third surface of the second board, and disposed inside the protrusion, wherein the second window is spaced part and under the second sensor circuit.

(111) The electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may further include a magnet **710** mounted at a position corresponding to the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) in a fourth surface opposite to the third surface of the second board so that the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) mounted on the third surface of the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**) is fixed on the second board.

(112) The electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may further include a processor **120** mounted on the first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**); and, when the protrusion **206** is implemented to be pushable, the processor **210** may be configured to, in response to detection of a push signal to the protrusion **206**, activate the first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) and/or the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**), and obtain user's biometric information through the first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) and/or the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**).

(113) The electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may further include a light source **620** mounted on the second surface of the second board (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485**).

(114) FIG. **8** is a cross-sectional view **800** of the electronic device **400** viewed along line A-A' in FIG. **5A** according to certain embodiments.

(115) In describing the components of the electronic device **400** shown in FIG. **8**, the same reference symbols are assigned to the components substantially the same as those of the electronic device **400** described above in FIG. **6**, and detailed descriptions thereof may be omitted.

(116) With reference to FIG. **8**, the electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may include a protrusion **206** (e.g., biometric recognition module or structure) that is formed to protrude from one side surface of the housing **210** and includes an internal space **530**. In certain embodiments, the protrusion **206** may be configured to be rotatable. When the protrusion **206** is configured to be rotatable, the protrusion **206** may operate as an input means according to the design method. In one embodiment, at least a portion of the outer shape of the protrusion **206**, for example, the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** may be made of a transparent window.

(117) In certain embodiments, the electronic device **400** may include a printed circuit board **480** disposed in the internal space of the housing **210**. The electronic device **400** may include a first flexible printed circuit board **803** (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485** in FIGS. **4** to **7**) connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the printed circuit board **480**.

(118) In FIGS. **4** and **7** described above according to certain embodiments, it has been described that a plurality of sensors and/or light sources are mounted on the flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the printed circuit board **480** through a hole (e.g., hole **510** in FIGS. **5** to **7**), but the disclosure is not limited thereto. In FIG. **8** according to certain embodiments, the electronic device **400** may further include a second flexible

printed circuit board **805** disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206** separately from the first flexible printed circuit board **803**. A plurality of sensors and/or light sources may be mounted on the second flexible printed circuit board **805**. For example, a fingerprint sensor **610**, a light source **620**, and/or an illuminance sensor **640** may be mounted on a first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the second flexible printed circuit board **805**. A heart rate sensor **630** may be mounted on a second surface of the second flexible printed circuit board **805** (e.g., second surface facing in the negative z-axis direction opposite to the direction of the first surface).

(119) In certain embodiments, a plurality of connection members may be positioned between the first flexible printed circuit board **803** (e.g., flexible printed circuit board **485** in FIGS. **4** to **7**) and the second flexible printed circuit board **805**. The second flexible printed circuit board **805** may be electrically connected to the first flexible printed circuit board **803** through the plural connection members. For example, the plural connection members may be made of conductors so as to electrically connect the first flexible printed circuit board **803** and the second flexible printed circuit board **805**. For instance, the plural connection members may include a plurality of conductive members and a plurality of conductive pads. For example, the conductive members may include a C clip (e.g., C-shaped spring), a pogo-pin, a spring, conductive phorone, conductive rubber, conductive tape, or a copper connector. However, they are not limited thereto.

(120) In certain embodiments, the plural connection members may include a first conductive member **810a**, a second conductive member **810b**, a first conductive pad **820a**, and a second conductive pad **820b**.

(121) In certain embodiments, the first conductive member **810a** and the first conductive pad **820a** may be bonded to each other to be integrally formed. The first flexible printed circuit board **803** and the first conductive member **810a** may be electrically connected through a first conductive path **830**, and the first conductive pad **820a** and the second flexible printed circuit board **805** may be electrically connected through a second conductive path **835**. Accordingly, the first flexible printed circuit board **803** and the second flexible printed circuit board **805** may be electrically connected through the first conductive member **810a**, the first conductive path **830**, the first conductive pad **820a**, and the second conductive path **835**.

(122) In certain embodiments, the second conductive member **810b** and the second conductive pad **820b** may be bonded to each other to be integrally formed. The first flexible printed circuit board **803** and the second conductive member **810b** may be electrically connected through a third conductive path **840**, and the second conductive pad **820b** and the second flexible printed circuit board **805** may be electrically connected through a fourth conductive path **845**. Accordingly, the first flexible printed circuit board **803** and the second flexible printed circuit board **805** may be electrically connected through the second conductive member **810b**, the third conductive path **840**, the second conductive pad **820b**, and the fourth conductive path **845**.

(123) In certain embodiments, as the first flexible printed circuit board **803** and the second flexible printed circuit board **805** are electrically connected through the plural connection members (e.g., first conductive member **810a**, first conductive pad **820a**, second conductive member **810b**, and second conductive pad **820b**), the first conductive path **830**, the second conductive path **835**, the third conductive path **840**, and the fourth conductive path **845**, the processor **120** mounted on the printed circuit board **480** connected to the first flexible printed circuit board **803** may be electrically connected to the plural sensors (e.g., plural biometric sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**, heart rate sensor **630**), and/or illuminance sensor **640**) mounted on the second flexible printed circuit board **805**. As the processor **120** mounted on the printed circuit board **480** is electrically connected to the plural sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**, heart rate sensor **630**), and/or illuminance sensor **640**) mounted on the second flexible printed circuit board **805**, the processor **120** may obtain user's biometric information (e.g., fingerprint information and/or heart rate information) through the plural sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610** and/or heart rate sensor **630**), and/or may detect

proximity of an external object (e.g., body portion of the user) on the window (e.g., first surface **520a** and/or third surface **520c** of the protrusion **206**) through the illuminance sensor **640**.

(124) An electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments may include: a housing **210**; a protrusion (e.g., protrusion **206**) from a side surface of the housing including a first window (e.g., first window formed on at least a portion of the first surface **520a**) and a second window (e.g., second window formed on at least a portion of the third surface **520c**), a first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**) disposed inside the housing **210**; a second board (e.g., first flexible printed circuit board **803**) connected to one surface of the first board; a third board (e.g., second flexible printed circuit board **805**) electrically connected to the second board through a plurality of connection members; a first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) disposed on a first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the third board, and wherein the first window is spaced apart above the first sensor circuit; and a second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) disposed on a second surface (e.g., second surface facing in negative z-axis direction being opposite to the direction of the first surface) of the third board, and wherein the second window disposed to be spaced apart under the second sensor circuit.

(125) In certain embodiments, the plurality of connection members may include a plurality of conductive members and a plurality of conductive pads.

(126) In certain embodiments, the plurality of conductive members may include a first conductive member **810a** and a second conductive member **810b**, and the plurality of conductive pads may include a first conductive pad **820a** and a second conductive pad **820b**; the first conductive member **810a** and the first conductive pad **820a** may be bonded to each other to be integrally formed, and the second conductive member **810b** and the second conductive pad **820b** may be bonded to each other to be integrally formed.

(127) In certain embodiments, the electronic device **400** may further include: a first conductive connection member **830** electrically connecting the second board (e.g., first flexible printed circuit board **803**) and the first conductive member **810a**; a second conductive connection member **835** electrically connecting the first conductive pad **820a** and the third board (e.g., second flexible printed circuit board **805**); a third conductive connection member **840** electrically connecting the second board (e.g., first flexible printed circuit board **803**) and the second conductive member **810b**; and a fourth conductive connection member **845** electrically connecting the second conductive pad **820b** and the third board (e.g., second flexible printed circuit board **805**).

(128) In certain embodiments, the electronic device **400** may further include a processor **120** mounted on the first board (e.g., printed circuit board **480**), and the processor **120** may be electrically connected to the first sensor circuit (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**) and the second sensor circuit (e.g., heart rate sensor **630**) mounted on the third board (e.g., second flexible printed circuit board **805**) through the second board (e.g., first flexible printed circuit board **803**), the first conductive connection member **830**, the second conductive connection member **835**, the third conductive connection member **840**, and the fourth conductive connection member **845**.

(129) FIG. **9** is a view **900** for explaining a window formed on one surface of the protrusion **206** when the fingerprint sensor **610** is made of an optical fingerprint sensor according to certain embodiments.

(130) In describing the components of the electronic device **400** shown in FIG. **9**, the same reference symbols are assigned to the components substantially the same as those of the electronic device **400** described above in FIG. **6**, and detailed descriptions thereof may be omitted.

(131) With reference to FIG. **9**, the electronic device **400** may include a protrusion **206** (e.g., biometric recognition module or structure) that is formed to protrude from one side surface of the housing **210** and includes an internal space **530**. In one embodiment, at least a portion of the outer shape of the protrusion **206**, for example, the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** may be made of a transparent window.

(132) In certain embodiments, the electronic device **400** may include a printed circuit board **480**

disposed in the internal space of the housing **210**. The electronic device **400** may include a flexible printed circuit board **485** connected to one surface (e.g., surface facing in x-axis direction) of the printed circuit board **480**. A fingerprint sensor **610** may be mounted on the first surface (e.g., first surface facing in z-axis direction) of the flexible printed circuit board **485**, and a heart rate sensor **630** may be mounted on the second surface (e.g., second surface facing in negative z-axis direction) of the flexible printed circuit board **485**.

(133) In certain embodiments, the fingerprint sensor **610** mounted on the first surface of the flexible printed circuit board **485** may be an optical fingerprint sensor.

(134) In certain embodiments, to widen the angle-of-view **920**, a lens may be applied to the transparent window that forms at least a portion of the outer shape (e.g., first surface **520a**, second surface **520b**, and/or third surface **520c**) of the protrusion **206**. For example, when a user's finger **910** is positioned on the outer shape, for example, the first surface **520a**, the second surface **520b**, and/or the third surface **520c** of the protrusion **206**, at least a portion of the outer shape being made of a window, light emitted from the light source **620** may pass through the window forming one surface of the protrusion **206** on which the user's finger **910** is positioned and may be reflected by the user's finger **910**. The light reflected by the user's finger **910** may be collected on the transparent window to which the lens is applied, and may be received by the light receiving part of the fingerprint sensor **610**. As the lens is applied to the window that forms at least a portion of the outer shape of the protrusion **206** (e.g., first surface **520a**, second surface **520b**, and/or third surface **520c**), the area (e.g., angle-of-view **920**) that can collect the light reflected by the user's finger **910** may be widened, and hence a larger area of the user's finger **910** can be captured compared to a case where no lens is applied to the window. As a large area of the user's finger **910** can be captured, the recognition rate of the fingerprint sensor **610** may be increased.

(135) In the electronic device **400** of FIGS. **2** to **9** according to certain embodiments, a plurality of sensors (e.g., fingerprint sensor **610**, heart rate sensor **630**, and/or illuminance sensor **640**) capable of measuring user's biometric information can be disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206** formed to protrude from a side surface of the electronic device **400**, which can improve the accuracy of biometric recognition. In addition, compared to a related-art case where a plurality of sensors are disposed in the internal space of the electronic device, as a plurality of sensors are disposed in the internal space **530** of the protrusion **206** formed to protrude from a side surface of the electronic device **400** according to certain embodiments of the disclosure, it is possible to realize slimming of the electronic device **400**.

(136) Hereinabove, certain embodiments of the disclosure have been shown and described for the purpose of illustration without limiting the subject matter of the disclosure. It should be understood that many variations and modifications of the basic inventive concept described herein will still fall within the spirit and scope of the disclosure as defined in the appended claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. An electronic device comprising: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing, the protrusion comprising a first surface facing a first direction and a second surface facing a second direction opposite the first direction; a first window forming at least a portion of the first surface of the protrusion; a second window forming at least a portion of the second surface of the protrusion; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board electrically connected to the first board; a first sensor circuit mounted on a first surface of the second board facing the first direction, disposed in the protrusion, and configured to obtain a first biometric signal through the first window; and a second sensor circuit mounted on a second surface of the second board facing the second direction, disposed in the protrusion, spaced apart from the second window, and configured to obtain a second biometric signal through the second window, wherein a type of the first biometric signal is

different from a type of the second biometric signal.

2. The electronic device of claim 1, wherein the first board includes a printed circuit board, and the second board includes a flexible printed circuit board.

3. The electronic device of claim 1, further comprising a hole connecting an internal space of the housing and an internal space of the protrusion.

4. The electronic device of claim 3, wherein the second board passes through the hole from one surface of the first board and is disposed in the internal space of the protrusion.

5. The electronic device of claim 1, wherein the first biometric signal comprises a fingerprint of a user; and wherein the second biometric signal comprises a heart rate of the user.

6. The electronic device of claim 1, further comprising at least one of an illuminance sensor d/or a light source mounted on the first surface of the second board.

7. The electronic device of claim 6, wherein the first sensor circuit and the second sensor circuit mounted on the second board are electrically connected to a processor mounted on the first board.

8. The electronic device of claim 7, wherein the processor is configured to: detect whether a body portion of a user is placed on the first window through the illuminance sensor, when the body portion of the user is placed on the first window, activate at least one of the first sensor circuit or the second sensor circuit, and obtain at least one of the first biometric signal or second biometric signal through at least one of the first sensor circuit or the second sensor circuit.

9. The electronic device of claim 8, wherein the first sensor circuit includes a fingerprint sensor, and wherein the processor is configured to: emit, in response to detecting a finger of the user on the first window, light to the user's finger through the light source; and obtain fingerprint information of the user based on receiving, through the fingerprint sensor, the emitted light that has been reflected by the user's finger detected on the first window.

10. The electronic device of claim 9, wherein the fingerprint sensor is an optical fingerprint sensor, and a lens is applied to the first window and/or the second window and configured to increase an area for collecting light reflected by the finger.

11. The electronic device of claim 8, wherein the second sensor circuit includes a heart rate sensor; and wherein the processor is configured to obtain heart rate information of the user based on emitting light toward a wrist of the user through a light emitting part of the heart rate sensor and receiving the emitted light that has been reflected by the user's wrist through a light receiving part of the heart rate sensor.

12. An electronic device comprising: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing, the protrusion comprising a first surface facing a first direction and a second surface facing a second direction perpendicular to the first direction; a first window forming at least a portion of the first surface of the protrusion; a second window forming at least a portion of the second surface of the protrusion; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board electrically connected to the first board, the second board including a first surface facing the first direction, and a second surface facing the second direction; a first sensor circuit mounted on the first surface of the second board and disposed inside the protrusion, wherein the first sensor circuit is configured to obtain a first biometric signal through the first window; and a second sensor circuit mounted on the second surface of the second board, and disposed inside the protrusion, wherein the second sensor circuit is spaced apart from the second window and configured to obtain a second biometric signal through the second window, wherein a type of the first biometric signal is different from a type of the second biometric signal.

13. The electronic device of claim 12, further comprising a magnet that is mounted at a position corresponding to the second sensor circuit in a third surface opposite to the second surface of the second board so as to fix the second sensor circuit mounted on the second surface of the second board on the second board.

14. The electronic device of claim 12, further comprising a processor mounted on the first board, and wherein the protrusion is pushable, and the processor is configured to, in response to detection

of a push signal to the protrusion, activate at least one of the first sensor circuit or the second sensor circuit, and obtain at least one biometric information through the at least one of the first sensor circuit or the second sensor circuit.

15. The electronic device of claim 12, further comprising a light source mounted on the first surface of the second board.

16. An electronic device comprising: a housing; a protrusion from a side surface of the housing, the protrusion comprising a first surface facing a first direction and a second surface facing a second direction opposite the first direction; a first window forming at least a portion of the first surface of the protrusion; second window forming at least a portion of the second surface of the protrusion; a first board disposed inside the housing; a second board electrically connected to the first board; a third board electrically connected to the second board through a plurality of connection members; a first sensor circuit disposed on a first surface of the third board facing the first direction, and wherein the first sensor circuit is configured to obtain a first biometric signal through the first window; and a second sensor circuit disposed on a second surface of the third board facing the second direction, and wherein the second sensor circuit disposed to be spaced apart from the second window and configured to obtain a second biometric signal through the second window, wherein a type of the first biometric signal is different from a type of the second biometric signal.

17. The electronic device of claim 16, wherein the plurality of connection members includes a plurality of conductive members and a plurality of conductive pads.

18. The electronic device of claim 17, wherein the plurality of conductive members includes a first conductive member and a second conductive member; wherein the plurality of conductive pads includes a first conductive pad and a second conductive pad; and wherein the first conductive member and the first conductive pad are bonded to each other to be integrally formed, and the second conductive member and the second conductive pad are bonded to each other to be integrally formed.

19. The electronic device of claim 18, further comprising: a first conductive connection member to electrically connect the second board and the first conductive member; a second conductive connection member to electrically connect the first conductive pad and the third board; a third conductive connection member to electrically connect the second board and the second conductive member; and a fourth conductive connection member to electrically connect the second conductive pad and the third board.

20. The electronic device of claim 19, further comprising a processor mounted on the first board, and wherein the processor is electrically connected to the first sensor circuit and the second sensor circuit mounted on the third board through the second board, the first conductive connection member, the second conductive connection member, the third conductive connection member, and the fourth conductive connection member.
